

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 10, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 60

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 52380.66 ▼ 405.41 0.77% NASDAQ 26253.34 ▼ 0.6% STOXX 600 640.41 ▼ 1.41% 10-YR.TREAS. ▼ 8/32, yield 4.836% OIL \$96.05 ▲ \$3.02 GOLD \$4,416.00 ▲ \$22.10 EURO \$1.1635 YEN 153.54

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **U.S. government** bond yields climbed to fresh multiyear highs, with the 10-year note settling at 4.836%. Among stock indexes, the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq shed 0.5%, 0.8% and 0.6%, respectively. **A1**
- ◆ **European natural-gas** prices surged to their highest level since early 2023 as escalating attacks in the Middle East continue to choke LNG shipments. **A6**
- ◆ **Apple introduced** its first foldable iPhone, one that fits comfortably in a pocket and allows users to engage with more than one app at a time. **B1**
- ◆ **An Anthropic researcher** quit the artificial-intelligence industry over fears that the lab and its competitors are racing to build systems they won't be able to control. **B1, B4**
- ◆ **Andrew Tulloch**, the star AI researcher who was offered a pay package worth more than \$1 billion to join Meta Platforms last year, is leaving the company. **B4**
- ◆ **Alphabet's Google** said it would spend more than \$15 billion to develop artificial-intelligence infrastructure in Finland. **B6**
- ◆ **Analog Devices** struck a deal to acquire Alif Semiconductor, a maker of microcontrollers and fusion processors, for \$1.35 billion. **B4**
- ◆ **Inspire Brands** named the head of its Dunkin' division as interim chief executive as the fast-food company prepares for an IPO. **B3**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** requested additional information from Fox Corp. and Roku as the companies work to complete a roughly \$25 billion deal. **B5**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Iran is increasingly** trying to escalate its conflict with the U.S. as it seeks to break a stalemate in the Strait of Hormuz that is strangling its economy. **A1, A7**
- ◆ **Top White House** advisers have raised with Trump the prospect that the Iran war could drag on through the remainder of his term. **A7**
- ◆ **Steve Witkoff**, Trump's Middle East envoy, reported earning more than \$100 million from the entity that owns his stake in World Liberty Financial. **A4**
- ◆ **Rhode Island Gov.** Dan McKee was soundly defeated in his state's Democratic primary, making him the first sitting U.S. governor to lose a primary contest in nearly a decade. **A4**
- ◆ **The Office of** Congressional Conduct cleared Minnesota Rep. Ilhan Omar of wrongdoing in connection with documents she submitted to Congress that dramatically overstated her wealth. **A4**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is proposing to overhaul the 2030 census by eliminating questions about race and ethnicity and restricting how immigrants would be counted. **A3**
- ◆ **This year, about 92%** of U.S. health providers either encourage prepayment, require it or collect a payment method on file during the estimate process, a jointly sponsored survey found. **A3**
- ◆ **The Justice Department's** prosecution of Huawei for allegedly stealing trade secrets from U.S. companies looms over talks between Trump and Xi Jinping scheduled for later this month. **A5**
- ◆ **Police opened** a criminal investigation into allegations that anti-immigration party Reform UK broke rules barring foreign donations. **A7**

CONTENTS Markets Digest..... B7
Arts in Review..... A12 Opinion..... A13-15
Business & Finance B25-6 Personal Journal A10-11
Business News..... B3 Sports..... A16
Crossword..... A11 Technology..... B4
Heard on Street..... B11 U.S. News..... A2-5
Markets..... B10 World News..... A6-9
© 2026 Dow Jones & Company, Inc.
All Rights Reserved

Trump Puts Himself Front and Center for GOP



JARIN BOSCHARD FOR WSJ

PARTY PROMOTER: President Trump gave the keynote speech Wednesday night at the opening of the Republican midterm convention in Dallas, which the party hopes will energize voters. It was the first of two straight days he was to speak. **A4**

Iran Looks to Escalate Conflict In Bid to Break Strait Impasse

Tehran's forces have fired at U.S. warships, coming much closer than in previous tries

Iran is increasingly trying to escalate its conflict with the U.S. as it seeks to break a stalemate in the Strait of Hormuz

By Georgi Kantchev, Shelby Holliday and Costas Paris

that is strangling its economy. At least three times in the past week, Iranian forces have launched missiles at U.S. warships, including an aircraft

carrier, taking direct aim at the U.S. Navy in a way it hasn't done since the start of the war. Iran also fired a large missile salvo at U.S. forces stationed in Jordan on Wednesday. The attempted strikes on warships have led to much closer calls than previous attempts, with Iran using maneuverable warheads, people familiar with the attacks said. The warships evaded the attacks, said U.S. Central Command, which is responsible for the Middle East. Still, the attacks have left U.S. officials increasingly concerned that Iran has improved its ability to target ships, perhaps with help from Russia or China, the peo-

ple said. The attacks are pushing the war into a more perilous phase. A hit on a U.S. warship would almost certainly trigger a fierce U.S. response and risk reigniting a full-scale war. The gamble is a significant step up from the measured attacks Iran has been carrying out for weeks against commercial ships in the strait and less sensitive U.S. targets in Kuwait, Bahrain and Jordan. Iran continued to fire at U.S. warships even after the U.S. struck Iranian tankers in response. Iran has grown more aggressive as the vise around its economy tightens. Nineteen

U.S. Navy ships are enforcing a blockade that has shut down its oil exports. New U.S. sanctions have disrupted Tehran's finances, sending its currency tumbling and forcing cuts to fuel subsidies. "Iran is escalating because they don't see other options," said Marc Sievers, a former U.S. ambassador to Oman, which sits across the strait. "They're under tremendous pressure from the blockade and the new sanctions." For Tehran, the aim is less to match U.S. military power

◆ **Trump is told war could last through end of term..... A7**

Treasury Buyback Fails to Ease Rise In Yields

Multiyear highs are reached as Bessent moves to repurchase \$6 billion in debt

By HANNAH ERIN LANG AND SAM GOLDFARB

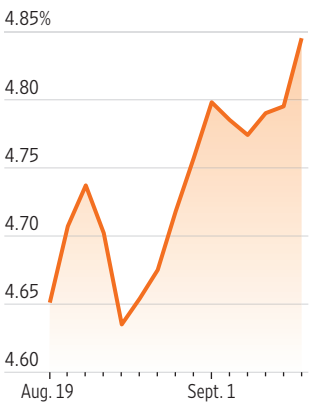
U.S. government bond yields climbed to fresh multiyear highs on Wednesday after the Treasury Department said it would repurchase as much as \$6 billion of longer-term debt at a buyback operation on Thursday, disappointing some investors who had thought that a larger amount was possible.

For Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, who promised to go big to bring down bond yields, his efforts, so far, aren't big enough.

The Treasury had already said last month that it would at least double buybacks of longer-term bonds from a maximum of \$2 billion per operation, expanding a program that was originally intended to improve liquidity in older, less frequently traded securities. Investors widely viewed that as an effort to contain

Please turn to page A2

U.S. 10-year Treasury note



Source: Tullett Prebon

◆ **Owning bonds when they are selling off..... A10**

Caregiver Lapses Exacerbate Outbreak Of Ebola

By NICHOLAS BARIYO

KAMPALA, Uganda—Efforts to halt the spread of the Congo's deadliest outbreak of Ebola are faltering. Health workers are going unpaid. Locals are challenging health officials over how the disease spreads and questioning whether it even exists at all. In the latest sign of just how badly things are going, health workers who are angry about unpaid wages have violated basic Ebola control protocols and allowed grieving families to touch the bodies of relatives killed by the virus—an act almost certain to spread the disease. Aid workers have witnessed such events, and in at least one case filmed them. The epidemic in the Democratic Republic of Congo has killed more than 3,200 people. The World Health Organization warns the death toll is likely to exceed the worst Ebola epidemic on record, which raged through West Africa between 2014 and 2016, leaving 11,000 dead in its wake. Health experts said the virus can be stopped if communities adhere to strict health protocols. But Congo's Ebola epicenter is in a remote region plagued by Islamic State insurgents, a variety of other militant groups and deep suspi-

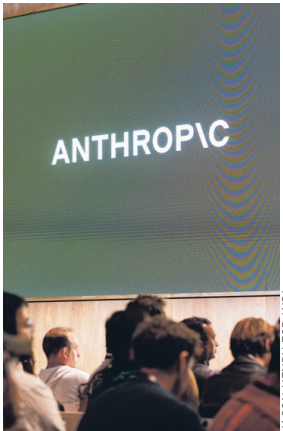
Please turn to page A8

INSIDE



JULIAN FINNEY/GETTY IMAGES

JASON GAY Shelton defeats Alcaraz in a glorious match that finished at an inhumane hour. **A16**



JASON HENRY FOR WSJ

BUSINESS & FINANCE Anthropic researcher quits over fears of AI models spiraling out of human control. **B1**

They Hit the AI Jackpot— And Bought Espresso Machines

Bay Area's newest millionaires don't have the time or interest in reaping the rewards

By KATHERINE BINDLEY

There's more money floating around the Bay Area than people have ever seen. If only those making it knew how to spend it. People working for AI companies are so busy and unfocused on traditional markers of wealth, many have yet to fully embrace the fruits of that labor. They might book a custom bike trip through Italy, if they can spare the time off from work. A luxury backyard



Money to burn

sauna and cold plunge could make sense for decompressing. But pouring money into a kitchen that isn't going to be used is a hard no. And millions can go toward a new home, of course, as evidenced by the San Francisco real-estate market. But investing in art for their walls? Not a priority among this cohort. "They are not flashy," says Garret Spiecker, a senior managing director at Citizens Private Bank who runs the pre-

Please turn to page A11

Giant Floods Crash Nepal's Energy Bet

Hundreds of hydropower projects are threatened by instability in Himalayas

KATHMANDU, Nepal—When a flood came roaring down from the mountains last year, Nepali engineer

By Niharika Mandhana, Krishna Pokharel and Tripti Lahiri

Santosh Adhikari narrowly escaped by scrambling to higher ground. Two weeks ago, another surge barreled down—this one bigger and

faster, an unstoppable torrent of water, ice, rock, mud and horror. The wave tore through the Rasuwagadhi hydropower plant where Adhikari served as the manager, ripping up steel and concrete defenses with explosive force and pouring into the project's cavernous tunnels. Within seconds, it swallowed the cluster of buildings where the

Please turn to page A9

Retailers Clamp Down On Easy Online Returns

By ESTHER FUNG

It's not your imagination. Returning online orders is getting harder. U.S. consumers accustomed to free and easy returns are smarting from surprise fees, shorter return windows, delayed refunds and more questions about their reasons for sending products back. A few are getting warnings that they won't get a refund on their next return. April Bradley recently bristled at having to pay \$7.95 to return a pair of Lane Bryant jeans she had purchased online that didn't fit. The Warren County, N.J., resident said she would have preferred to try

them on before purchasing, but a nearby Lane Bryant store had closed a few years ago. Lane Bryant wouldn't allow a free, direct exchange for another size, either. So she prepaid for a shipping label and drove to a parcel-shipping center to drop it off. "I sent an angry message to them," said Bradley, who concedes she can sometimes be a difficult customer. The company responded with an apology and an \$8 credit. Sixty-eight percent of retailers now charge a fee on returns at least some of the time, up from 43% five years ago, according to Loop Returns, an e-commerce returns-

Please turn to page A4